

Mark Smalley

Digital Assets · Regulatory Strategy · Blockchain Infrastructure

Seeking senior roles at RegTech, FinTech, or legal/advisory firms · UK/Europe & remote

mark@smalley.my · +44 (0) 7526 860 262 · smalley.my · Nationality: British · linkedin.com/in/msmalley

Executive Summary

15 years building compliance-grade blockchain infrastructure while simultaneously shaping the regulatory frameworks that govern it. First company in SC Malaysia's digital asset sandbox; co-founded Malaysia's first regulated custodian; delivered to DBS Bank and Baker Hostetler. Now UK-based, seeking senior RegTech/FinTech roles where regulatory fluency and production engineering intersect.

Regulatory & Advisory Credentials

- First company admitted to the Securities Commission Malaysia (SC) regulatory sandbox for digital assets
- Active contributor to Malaysia's national Digital Asset regulatory roadmap — engaged directly with SC and Bank Negara Malaysia stakeholders
- Advised on Project Castor — the Securities Commission's blockchain blueprint that established Digital Asset Custodian requirements in Malaysian capital markets
- Co-founded and funded CoKeeps — Malaysia's first regulated digital asset custodian — providing two years of product development capital and three years of operational funding through R1
- Delivered blockchain and distributed ledger training and advisory to DBS Bank (Singapore) and Baker Hostetler (USA)
- Presented on regulatory dimensions of blockchain at the Islamic Finance News Forum (KL, 2017) and the Financial Crime Summit (2017)
- Presented at MDEC FinTech Conference and Finnovasia — addressing institutional audiences on regulatory compliance and digital asset adoption
- Registered HRDF Trainer — designed and delivered multi-day blockchain compliance workshops for financial institutions
- Deloitte Top 50 Global RegTech Companies — Neuroware was the only Malaysian company listed (2017)

Work Experience

CEO & Founder R1 — Malaysia

2012 – 2025

Founded and led Malaysia's foremost blockchain infrastructure and regulatory advisory practice for 13 years. R1 sat at the intersection of engineering, compliance, and policy — building production-grade digital asset systems for licensed operators while advising regulators on the frameworks that would govern them.

- Established R1 as the first blockchain company to enter the SC Malaysia regulatory sandbox, engaging directly in the policy design process
- Designed and shipped compliant KYC and AML pipeline infrastructure adopted by licensed digital asset operators
- Co-founded, funded, and architected CoKeeps — Malaysia's first regulated digital asset custodian — investing two years of R1 capital into product development plus three operational years pending regulatory approval
- Delivered enterprise advisory engagements to DBS Bank (Singapore) and Baker Hostetler (USA) on blockchain compliance strategy
- Authored [DN-Key protocol](#) — decentralised key management via DNS TXT records, cited by name in the SC Malaysia capital markets blueprint and adopted by ATA Plus ECF for regulated custody
- Founded the Blockchain Embassy of Asia — Malaysia's first registered blockchain consortium with members from Maybank, RHB, Capital Bay, and ATA Plus
- Advised on Project Castor (2018) — the SC Malaysia blockchain blueprint that introduced Digital Asset Custodian regulation into capital markets. Technical implementation progressed from Dogecoin (distributed key-value storage) to Ethereum (ERC-20/721 token standards with programmable compliance)
- Built and maintained long-term relationships with Securities Commission Malaysia, central bank stakeholders, and regional FinTech bodies

Chief Blockchain Officer Oviato — United Kingdom

Feb 2025 – Mar 2026

Co-founded and led the technical pivot from consumer application to passkey-native identity and custody infrastructure — demonstrating how WebAuthN can meet institutional-grade security requirements. Secured DraperVC investment.

- Designed cryptographic framework and passkey/WebAuthN architecture for next-generation non-custodial wallet infrastructure
- Contributed to investor materials and technical due diligence process that resulted in DraperVC funding
- Demonstrated how passkey-native infrastructure can meet institutional-grade security requirements without traditional custodial risk

Head of Engineering CakeDefi — Singapore

Feb 2023 – Sep 2023

Engaged to design new Bitcoin meta-protocols and lead an innovation team. Co-authored the open SADO Protocol standard — an open-source, auditable trading infrastructure for Bitcoin assets.

- Co-authored [SADO Protocol](#) — open-source, self-authenticating decentralised order-book standard for Bitcoin Ordinals, with implications for compliant on-chain asset trading
- Demonstrated how open protocol design can underpin transparent, auditable trading infrastructure on Bitcoin

○ Chief Technology Officer

Neuroware Inc — USA / Malaysia

2013 - 2018

500 Startups-funded (Batch 9, US\$300K+ raised) company providing blockchain compliance infrastructure to licensed FinTech operators and regulators across Southeast Asia. Launched at TechCrunch Disrupt London. The only Malaysian company in Deloitte's Top 50 Global RegTech.

- Authored Everstore protocol (2016) — complete on-chain relational database engine with encryption tiers and audit trails, proving programmable blockchain capabilities to institutional clients before EVM existed
- Built blockchain infrastructure adopted by licensed financial institutions operating under regulatory oversight
- Helped Maybank implement MongoDB for their PFM module — the first bank in Asia to adopt MongoDB for personal financial management
- Engaged directly with regulators to demonstrate technical compliance with emerging distributed ledger frameworks
- Delivered hackathon infrastructure to DBS Bank; systems handled over 1 million API requests across the event

○ CEO & Founder (active)

Moddable Limited — United Kingdom

2025 - present

Technical studio applying AI-augmented engineering to algorithmic decision systems, pattern recognition engines, and automated risk-scoring architectures. Demonstrates continued production delivery using the same methodology applicable to compliance automation and regulatory tooling.

- Designed and shipped multi-depth search algorithms (iterative deepening, transposition tables, pattern recognition) and procedural generation systems — architectures directly transferable to algorithmic compliance scoring and transaction monitoring
- Built extensible plugin architecture and SDK platform with LLM-driven workflows, maintaining solo-founder velocity across 10+ concurrent repositories. Regulatory engagement model maps directly onto EU MiCA consultation process, FCA sandbox programmes, and PRA supervisory frameworks

Domain Expertise

Regulatory	Digital asset regulation, sandbox engagement, SC Malaysia, KYC/AML framework design, custody compliance
Technical	Blockchain protocol design, cryptographic infrastructure, passkeys/WebAuthN, smart contracts, AI-augmented workflows, algorithmic decision systems
Advisory	Institutional client delivery, FinTech strategy, whitepaper authorship, due diligence support, board-level briefing
Sectors	Digital asset custody, RegTech, Islamic Finance / FinTech, payments, identity, DeFi infrastructure
Geographies	United Kingdom, Malaysia, Singapore, Southeast Asia — regulatory environments across all jurisdictions
Framework Bridge	Malaysian sandbox engagement model maps directly onto EU MiCA graduated framework, FCA digital asset sandbox, and PRA supervisory approach — same regulatory lifecycle, different jurisdictions

Speaking & Publications

- TEDx Sarawak (2017) — 'The Cost of Cash': blockchain, digital currency, and financial inclusion
- Islamic Finance News Forum, Kuala Lumpur (2017) — gold, Bitcoin, and digital Sunnah instruments for Islamic Finance
- Financial Crime Summit (2017) — blockchain applications in financial crime prevention and compliance
- MDEC FinTech Conference — 'Banking on the Future of Blockchains': addressing institutional adoption
- Finnovasia — regional FinTech leadership forum, presenting on blockchain infrastructure for financial services
- Published: 'Unravelling Blockchain's Future' — IFN (Islamic Finance News), 2017

Credentials & Recognition

Deloitte Top 50 Global RegTech Companies	Digerati50 — Malaysia's Top 50 Digital Leaders
500 Startups Batch 9 — Top 5 by VentureBeat	Antler Malaysia Batch 2
Registered HRDF Trainer	Silver Duke of Edinburgh Award

References

Shafiu Hussain	U-Zyn Chua
CEO, Oviato · shaf@oviato.com	Founder & CT0, Cake Group (Singapore) · chua@uzyn.com